

crimes are committed in thy name!" The modern day philosopher might be justified in making the same remark about "stabilization," if some of the pseudo-stabilizing schemes so insistently urged for almost all departments of business, were actually and suddenly put into effect.

Despite all the attempted misuses of plans for stabilizing business, however, everyone recognizes that needless, irrational and unjustified changes in business conditions are almost universally harmful and deplorable. As a matter of fact, the effort to stabilize business is profoundly and vitally presupposed by the very processes of all civilization. On its material side, indeed, civilization might be defined as a process of eliminating or at least minimizing the risks and dangers of daily life. Slowly yet none the less steadily, civilization has lessened the individual's daily risk of physical violence. It has none the less strikingly worked to reduce the risks of sickness and disease. It is little wonder, therefore, that in the sphere of business no less than in the political and medical aspects of life, civilization is more and more incessantly demanding a similar cessation of the preventable risks attendant upon the individual in his economic life.

*If business stability is to be narrowly defined
as a complete lack of change . . . all progress
and invention must be ruled out as factors in
our future economic well-being.*

While undoubtedly the great popularity of the slogan "Stabilize business" is comparatively recent, the roots of the movement extend far back into history. Consciously or unconsciously, the desire for more dependable and steady economic conditions has prompted progressive legislation, and stimulated the development of sound business methods, for many centuries. But it has only been in the last half-century, when the overwhelming risks of war and disease